SalesIntel Tool

Capstone Project — Research & Planning Guide

Prepared for: Zoho Sales Team

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Overview

SalesIntel is a pre-meeting intelligence tool designed to help Zoho sales representatives prepare comprehensive company briefs before client meetings. The tool aggregates financial updates, social media activity, company website news, and third-party news coverage — then surfaces actionable pitch angles tailored to Zoho's product suite. This document outlines the five recommended B2B SaaS companies to target, the ten free API sources to power the tool, and the search strategy for each data category.

Section 1 — 5 B2B SaaS Target Companies for Zoho

All five companies below are publicly traded B2B SaaS firms, ensuring full coverage across all 10 data sources — including SEC EDGAR, Alpha Vantage, and Financial Modeling Prep (which require a public ticker). Each has active news, social media, and Reddit presence, making them ideal for SalesIntel demos.

#	Company	Ticker	~Employees	Why Zoho Should Pitch	Zoho Products to Lead With
1	Freshworks	FRSH	~4,700	CRM & helpdesk SaaS needing integrated payroll, expense & analytics. Competes with Zoho in some areas but Zoho One can undercut on price across the full suite.	Zoho Payroll, Zoho Expense, Zoho Analytics
2	Braze	BRZE	~1,700	Customer engagement platform scaling fast; needs CRM for its own sales org, plus HR & finance tools. Active news, Reddit, and SEC filing presence.	Zoho CRM, Zoho People, Zoho Books
3	Sprout Social	SPT	~900	Social media management SaaS with a growing sales team; uses Salesforce — Zoho can displace with a cost-effective integrated suite.	Zoho CRM, Zoho Campaigns, Zoho Desk
4	Amplitude	AMPL	~600	Product analytics firm that needs CRM, HR & finance tooling beyond its core product.	Zoho CRM, Zoho People, Zoho Books

#	Company	Ticker	~Employees	Why Zoho Should Pitch	Zoho Products to Lead With
				65+ SEC 8-K filings verified — rich financial signal.	
5	Zuora	ZUO	~1,000	Subscription management platform whose own ops team needs HR, project management & CRM. Actively hiring, strong news and social coverage.	Zoho People, Zoho Projects, Zoho CRM

All five are publicly traded on NASDAQ, ensuring SEC EDGAR filings, stock data, and financial statements are available. Each operates in a space adjacent to Zoho's products — using competitor tools (Salesforce, Workday, QuickBooks) that Zoho One can displace at significantly lower cost. All 10 data sources apply to every company.

API Coverage: All 10 APIs apply to all 5 companies. Tickers — Freshworks: FRSH, Braze: BRZE, Sprout Social: SPT, Amplitude: AMPL, Zuora: ZUO.

Section 2 — 10 Free APIs for Data Aggregation

All APIs below have free tiers suitable for a capstone project. Rate limits are noted — implement caching and request queuing to stay within limits. No paid plans are required.

#	Website	Free API Endpoint / Info	Applies To	What to Extract
1	NewsAPI.org	newsapi.org/v2/everything?q={company} — 100 req/day free	All 5 companies	Press releases, product launches, leadership changes, funding news
2	The Guardian	open-platform.theguardian.com — free, no hard rate limit	All 5 companies	Tech sector news, company mentions, market commentary
3	GNews API	gnews.io/api/v4/search?q={company} — 100 req/day free	All 5 companies	Latest headlines, competitor mentions
4	Google News RSS	news.google.com/rss/search?q={company} — no API key needed	All 5 companies	Real-time news without API key — great fallback
5	Alpha Vantage	alphavantage.co — 25 req/day free. Use tickers: FRSH, BRZE, SPT, AMPL, ZUO.	All 5 companies	Stock price, EPS, revenue, P/E ratio, quarterly earnings
6	SEC EDGAR	efts.sec.gov/LATEST/search-index — fully free, no key. All 5 are public filers. Verified: 65 AMPL 8-Ks returned.	All 5 companies	10-K (annual), 10-Q (quarterly), 8-K (material events, leadership changes)
7	Financial Modeling Prep	financialmodelingprep.com/api/v3 — 250 req/day free. Use tickers: FRSH, BRZE, SPT, AMPL, ZUO.	All 5 companies	Income statement, balance sheet, cash flow, key metrics
8	Reddit API (PRAW)	reddit.com/search.json?q={company} — free read access	All 5 companies	Customer complaints, product feedback, competitor comparisons

#	Website	Free API Endpoint / Info	Applies To	What to Extract
9	Twitter/X API v2	Free basic tier (~1 app/month)	All 5 companies	Recent tweets, product announcements, executive quotes
10	Clearbit API	logo.clearbit.com/{domain} (logo free); company.clearbit.com (limited free)	All 5 companies	Company size, tech stack, industry, headcount, social handles

Category breakdown:

- News & Web (1–4): NewsAPI, The Guardian, GNews, Google RSS — primary sources for recent company coverage
- Financial (5–7): Alpha Vantage, SEC EDGAR, Financial Modeling Prep — earnings, filings, and key ratios
- Social Media (8–9): Reddit, Twitter/X — unfiltered customer and market sentiment
- Company Intelligence (10): Clearbit — company metadata, headcount, tech stack enrichment

Section 3 — Search Topics & Relevant Terms by Category

For each company brief, the AI layer should query the relevant APIs using the terms below. Replace {company} with the target company name. Prioritize terms that surface pain points and trigger events — these produce the highest-quality pitch angles.

Category	API Sources	Key Terms & Topics to Search
Financial Intel	SEC EDGAR, Alpha Vantage, FMP	"quarterly earnings", "revenue growth", "operating loss", "headcount reduction", "guidance lowered", "cash burn", "ARR", "NRR" (Net Revenue Retention)
Product & Strategy News	NewsAPI, Guardian, Google RSS	"{company} product launch", "{company} new feature", "{company} acquisition", "{company} partnership", "{company} layoffs", "{company} expansion", "{company} vs {competitor}"
Leadership Changes	SEC 8-K, News APIs	"new CTO", "new CFO", "CEO transition", "board appointment", "executive hire" — leadership changes = new buying decisions
Pain Points (Zoho sell-in)	Reddit, Twitter/X	"{company} pricing complaint", "{company} CRM issues", "{company} slow onboarding", "switched from {company}", "{company} alternative"
Social Media Signals	Twitter/X, Reddit	Company hashtags, product mentions, employee posts about internal tools, job postings mentioning competitor tools
Job Postings as Intent Signal	LinkedIn/Glassdoor scrape	"Salesforce", "HubSpot", "QuickBooks" in job descriptions — these are tools Zoho directly replaces, signal high conversion probability

Section 4 — Suggested AI Search Flow (Per Meeting Brief)

The following 7-step pipeline should run automatically when a sales rep inputs a company name. Each step feeds into the final AI-generated summary with pitch angle recommendations.

Step 1 — Company Enrichment

- Source: Clearbit API
- Input: Company domain (e.g., freshworks.com)
- Output: Logo, company size, industry, tech stack, headcount, social handles

Step 2 — Stock & Financial Data

- Source: Alpha Vantage + Financial Modeling Prep
- Input: Ticker symbol — FRSH (Freshworks), BRZE (Braze), SPT (Sprout Social), AMPL (Amplitude), ZUO (Zuora)
- Output: Current stock price, quarterly revenue, EPS, P/E ratio, YoY growth rate

Step 3 — Regulatory / Material Events

- Source: SEC EDGAR full-text search
- Input: Company name or CIK number
- Output: Last 90 days of 8-K filings (leadership changes, acquisitions, material events), latest 10-Q summary

Step 4 — News Coverage

- Source: NewsAPI + The Guardian + GNews + Google News RSS
- Input: Company name, CEO name
- Output: Top 10 articles from last 30 days — product launches, layoffs, partnerships, expansions

Step 5 — Social Signals

- Source: Twitter/X API v2
- Input: @CompanyHandle + CEO handle
- Output: Last 20 official tweets — announcements, tone, product focus areas

Step 6 — Market Sentiment

- Source: Reddit API (PRAW)
- Input: Company name as subreddit or search query
- Output: Top posts last 30 days — customer complaints, feature requests, competitor comparisons

Step 7 — AI Summary & Pitch Angle

- Input: Aggregated data from Steps 1–6
- Process: LLM summarizes key updates, identifies pain points, maps to Zoho product suite
- Output: 1-page brief with sections: Company Snapshot, Financial Health, Recent Events, Pain Points, Recommended Zoho Pitch

Section 5 — Pitch Strategy Notes

Highest Conversion Signals

- Job postings mentioning Salesforce, HubSpot, or QuickBooks — Zoho can displace these at lower cost
- SEC 8-K filings showing new CFO or CTO — new execs re-evaluate vendor relationships
- Earnings calls with slowing ARR or rising churn — financial pressure = openness to cost-saving tools
- Reddit threads with complaints about current CRM or finance tool — direct pain signal

Zoho's Core Pitch Angles

- Unified Suite: Replace 5–6 point solutions with one integrated platform
- Cost: Zoho One at ~$37/user/month vs. Salesforce + Slack + QuickBooks combined
- Sweet Spot Sizing: ~600-employee companies are large enough to need enterprise tools but small enough that Zoho One's all-in-one simplicity wins over Salesforce complexity
- Migration Support: Zoho provides white-glove CRM data migration from Salesforce/HubSpot